Task 4: Employee Offboarding Checklist

1. Purpose

This SOP provides a clear process for handling employee offboarding. It ensures that the employee's access, responsibilities, company property, and ongoing work are properly managed before and after their departure.

The process involves HR, IT, Management, and the departing employee.

2. Employee Offboarding Procedure

Step 1: HR Confirms the Departure

1. HR confirms the employee's last working day.
2. HR informs IT and the employee's manager about the departure.
3. HR confirms whether the departure is planned or requires immediate action.
4. HR communicates the required offboarding timeline to the relevant departments.
5. HR ensures that any required company policies or procedures are followed.

Step 2: Management Reviews the Employee's Responsibilities

1. The manager identifies the employee's active projects and responsibilities.
2. List any unfinished tasks, important deadlines, and pending work.
3. Identify who will take over each active project or responsibility.
4. Transfer important project information, files, and documentation to the appropriate team members.
5. Confirm that ongoing work has been properly handed over.

Step 3: IT Revokes System Access

IT should review and remove the employee's access to company systems and services.

Critical access to review includes:

1. Company email account
2. Company login and single sign-on (SSO)
3. VPN and remote access
4. Internal applications and business systems
5. Cloud storage and shared drives
6. Source-code repositories such as Git repositories
7. Code hosting and project management platforms
8. Cloud platforms and developer accounts
9. Database access
10. API keys, access tokens, and other authentication credentials
11. Development and testing environments
12. Administrative or privileged accounts
13. Collaboration and communication tools
14. Company-issued devices and other connected equipment

IT should also check whether the employee has access through any personal devices or secondary accounts that were authorized for company work.

Step 4: Secure Developer-Specific Access

For a software developer, IT or the appropriate technical administrator should pay particular attention to development-related access.

1. Disable access to source-code repositories.
2. Remove access to development and production environments.
3. Revoke active API keys and access tokens assigned to the employee.
4. Remove access to cloud services and developer consoles.
5. Review database permissions and remove unnecessary access.
6. Remove the employee from technical teams and permission groups.
7. Disable SSH keys or other credentials used to access company systems.
8. Check for personal access tokens or other credentials associated with company systems.
9. Transfer ownership of relevant repositories, projects, or technical resources.
10. Review whether any shared credentials need to be changed.

Step 5: HR Conducts the Exit Interview

HR conducts an exit interview with the departing employee.

Questions may include:

1. What was your overall experience with the organization?
2. What did you enjoy most about your role?
3. Were there any challenges that affected your work?
4. What improvements would you suggest?
5. Was there anything that made your work more difficult?
6. Is there any information you believe should be passed to your manager or team?
7. Do you have any company property that still needs to be returned?
8. Is there anything else you would like the organization to know before your departure?

HR records relevant feedback according to company policy.

Step 6: Company Property and Information

1. Collect company laptops, phones, access cards, keys, and other equipment.
2. Confirm that company property has been returned.
3. Check that important company files and documents have been transferred appropriately.
4. Ensure that confidential company information is not retained unnecessarily by the departing employee.
5. Record the return of company property.

Step 7: Final Access and Handover Check

Before the offboarding process is closed:

1. IT confirms that required accounts have been disabled.
2. Management confirms that active projects have been reassigned.
3. HR confirms that the exit interview and required documentation are complete.
4. Confirm that company property has been returned.
5. Confirm that important files, documents, and responsibilities have been transferred.
6. Record completion of the offboarding process.

AI Edge: Critical Cybersecurity Access Revocations

AI was used to identify the most important cybersecurity access that should be reviewed when a software developer leaves an organization.

The critical areas include:

1. Source-code repositories – revoke access to repositories and remove unnecessary repository permissions.
2. Cloud platforms – disable access to cloud accounts, developer consoles, and cloud resources.
3. API keys and access tokens – revoke active credentials associated with the departing employee.
4. Production and development environments – remove access to environments used to develop, test, or deploy software.
5. Database access – revoke database accounts and permissions.
6. VPN and remote access – disable remote connections to company systems.
7. SSH keys and authentication credentials – disable credentials used to access servers or other technical systems.
8. Administrative privileges – remove privileged or administrator-level access.
9. Single sign-on and identity accounts – disable the employee's main company identity and associated access.
10. Project and collaboration platforms – remove access to systems containing company or technical information.

The access review should be completed as part of the employee's offboarding process so that accounts and credentials are not left active after the employee's departure.